

## STAR SIGNS

### FEE FALLING

The superstars have fallen to earth. Even the smaller ones have tasted sawdust. Take a look how.

#### AKSHAY KUMAR



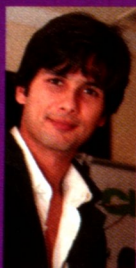
Charged Rs 35 crore plus a share of profits for *8X10 Tasveer* (there were none). Now offering a discounted rate of Rs 33.5 crore for any project in 2011, when he'll have dates to shoot.

#### SALMAN KHAN



From an astounding Rs 40 crore plus a profit share offer from T-Series, he's now completing Boney Kapoor's *Wanted* at Rs 10 crore and a share of the profits, if any.

#### SHAHID KAPUR



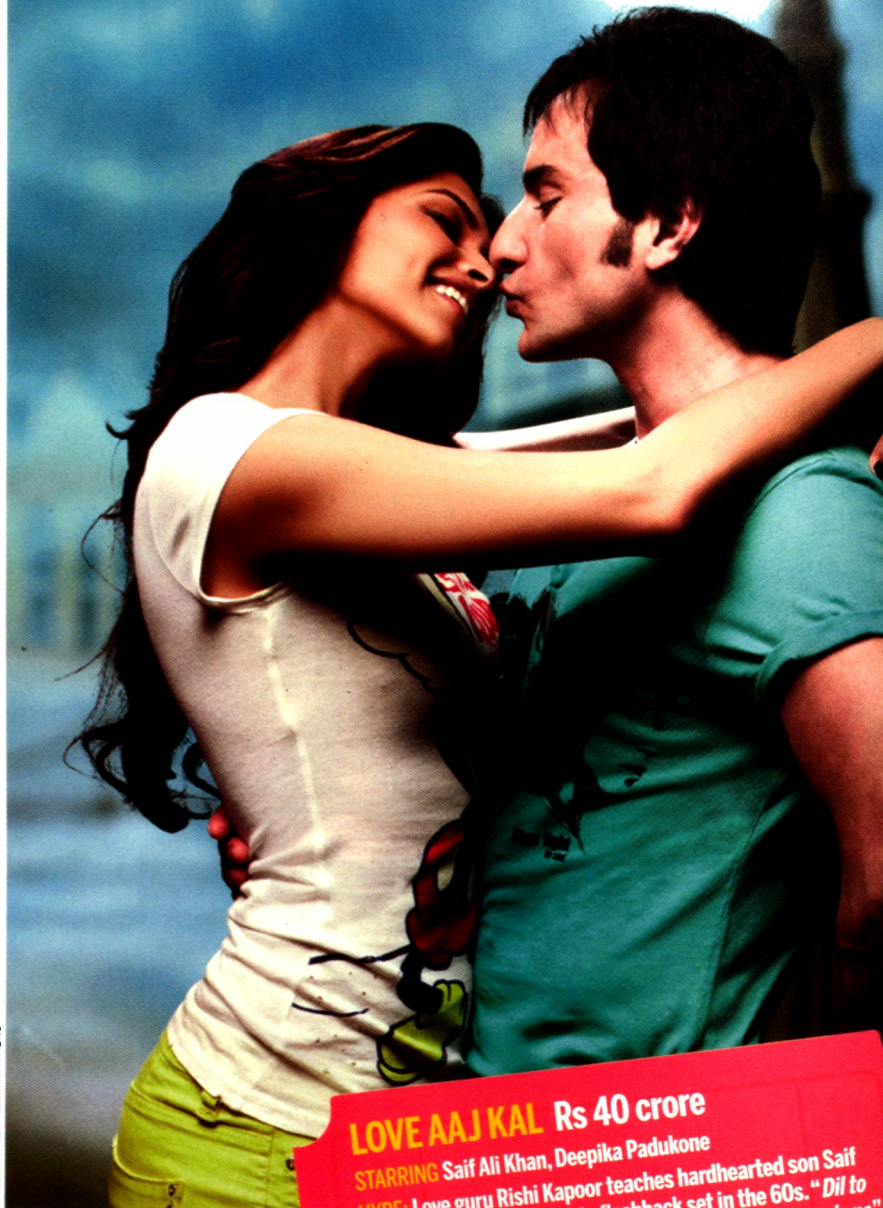
Demanded Rs 18 crore on the back of his success in *Vivah* and *Jab We Met*. Worked in *Kismet Konnection* for Rs 8 crore. Unlikely to get what he asked for.

#### JOHN ABRAHAM



Began charging Rs 12 crore plus one-third of the backend. Even *Dostana*'s success won't get him that price which may be why he has turned producer for Abbas Tyrewala's *I-800 Love*.

IMAGE COURTESY ILLUMINATI FILMS



### LOVE AAJ KAL Rs 40 crore

STARRING Saif Ali Khan, Deepika Padukone

**HYPE:** Love guru Rishi Kapoor teaches hardhearted son Saif what romance is all about in flashback set in the 60s. "*Dil to hota nahin hai tum logon ka. Sirf dimag diya hai uparwale ne.*"

**HOPE:** London, San Francisco, Kolkata, Delhi. Imtiaz Ali's road trip should meet love story at some point.

**STRIKE IMPACT** Release postponed by a month.

ers. The producers decided they wanted a higher share of the multiplex revenue. That was the problem. Multiplexes, which had built their own model of expansion, fuelled in large part by their commitments to shareholders and institutional investors and the great mall rush, had banked on extracting an increasing share from producers and raising ticket prices. Faced with a general election and an MP washout, producers decided it was as good a time as any to demand an equal share from multiplexes. The result: a strike that has lasted over two months, causing an operating loss of Rs 250 crore to multiplexes and a Rs 100-crore loss to producers in interest costs.

It's got everyone frantically checking their bank balance. With cash flows deferred, new projects have slowed down, and old deals are being renegotiated.

The Roshans wanted Rs 100 crore for *Kites*, their cross-cultural story of salsa, sex, sun and sand set in Las Vegas and the Santa Fe desert, starring Hrithik Roshan and Barbara Mori. Reliance is only willing to part with Rs 65 crore plus a 50:50 share of the overseas revenue, which it hopes will extend across 1,000 theatres in the US. Reliance has also scrapped the ambitious special effects saga *Talisman*, which was to be directed by Ram Madhvani and star Amitabh Bachchan, and passed up on Farhan Akhtar and Riteish Sidhwani's quirky *Kartik Calling Kartik* for which they were demanding Rs 30 crore.

What does it mean for the industry?